Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	31 January 2025
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Before you collaborate

10 minutes

A. Team gathering: Four team members joined the session: the project lead, a ServiceNow developer, a business analyst and an IT procurement coordinator. Relevant pre-work (current laptop request process, approval turnaround times, standard laptop catalog) was shared in advance.

B. Set the goal: Identify ideas for using Flow Designer to automate ordering of standard laptops, from request to delivery, with minimal manual handling.

C. Learn the facilitation tools: The team reviewed the facilitation superpowers to keep the session productive.

Define your problem statement

5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we automate standard laptop orders in ServiceNow using Flow Designer, so employees receive approved devices faster and IT spends less time on repetitive procurement work?

Key rules of brainstorming

- Stay in topic
- Defer judgment
- Go for volume
- Encourage wild ideas
- Listen to others
- If possible, be visual

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Brainstorm

10 minutes

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

> Tip: You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil (switch to sketch) icon to start drawing.

Team Member 1	Team Member 2	Team Member 3	Team Member 4
Service catalog item for standard laptops with pre-filled specs	Flow that skips approval for pre-approved roles	Check stock in asset inventory automatically	Notify requester at each stage (approved, shipped, delivered)
Auto-fill employee role, location and department from user record	Manager approval by email or mobile in one click	Auto-create purchase order when stock is low	Request status tracker on the portal
Limit requests to eligible employees only	Auto-escalate if approval is pending over 2 days	Assign vendor by region or contract price	Auto-create asset record and assign on delivery
Block duplicate requests within the refresh cycle	Budget check against cost center before approval	Reserve a laptop for new hires before day one	Dashboard of turnaround time and cost savings

Group ideas

20 minutes

Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. Each cluster is labeled with a sentence-like theme.

Make it easy to request the right laptop	Approve quickly without manual chasing	Fulfil from stock or vendor automatically
Standard laptop catalog item with pre-filled specs	Skip approval for pre-approved roles	Inventory check and reservation
Auto-fill details from user record	One-click manager approval	Auto-created purchase order when stock is low
Eligibility check and duplicate blocking	Auto-escalation of pending approvals	Vendor assignment by region or price
	Budget check by cost center	

Keep everyone informed	Close the loop and measure results
Stage-by-stage notifications	Auto-created asset record on delivery
Portal status tracker	Turnaround and savings dashboard

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Prioritize

20 minutes

Your team should all be on the same page about what is important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.



1. Skip approval for pre-approved roles
2. Standard laptop catalog item
3. Inventory check and reservation
4. Stage-by-stage notifications
5. Budget check by cost center
6. Auto-created purchase order
7. Auto-escalation of approvals
8. Auto-created asset record
9. Vendor assignment by region or price
10. Turnaround and savings dashboard

Importance: if each task could get done without any difficulty or cost, which would have the most positive impact?
Feasibility: regardless of importance, which tasks are more feasible than others?

Priority	Ideas	Decision
High importance, high feasibility	1, 2, 3, 4	Build first in Flow Designer
High importance, medium feasibility	5, 6, 7	Build next
Lower importance or lower feasibility	8, 9, 10	Plan for a later phase

Screenshots

Screenshots of the first ideas built in Flow Designer from the "Build first" group, tested end to end with request REQ0010001.

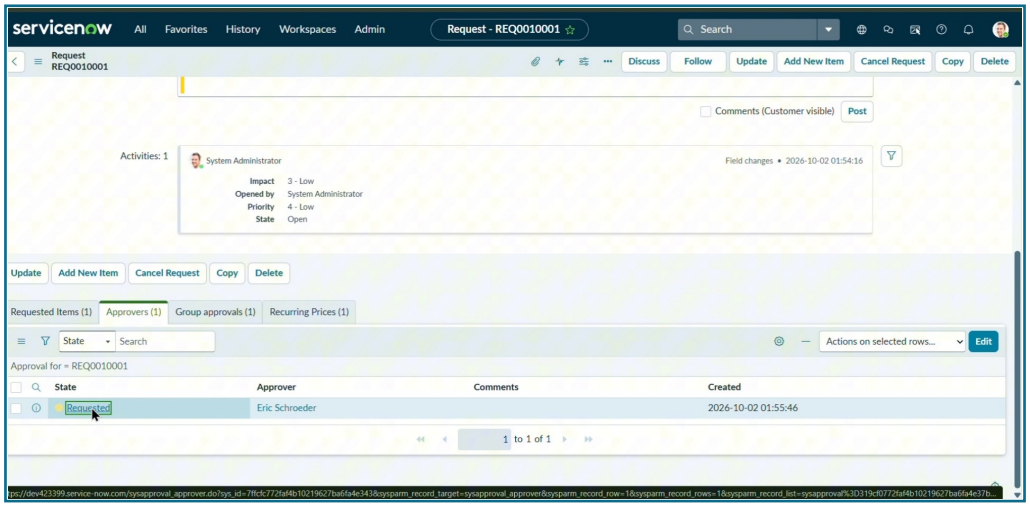


Figure 1: Approval record created for request REQ0010001 (approver listed on the request)

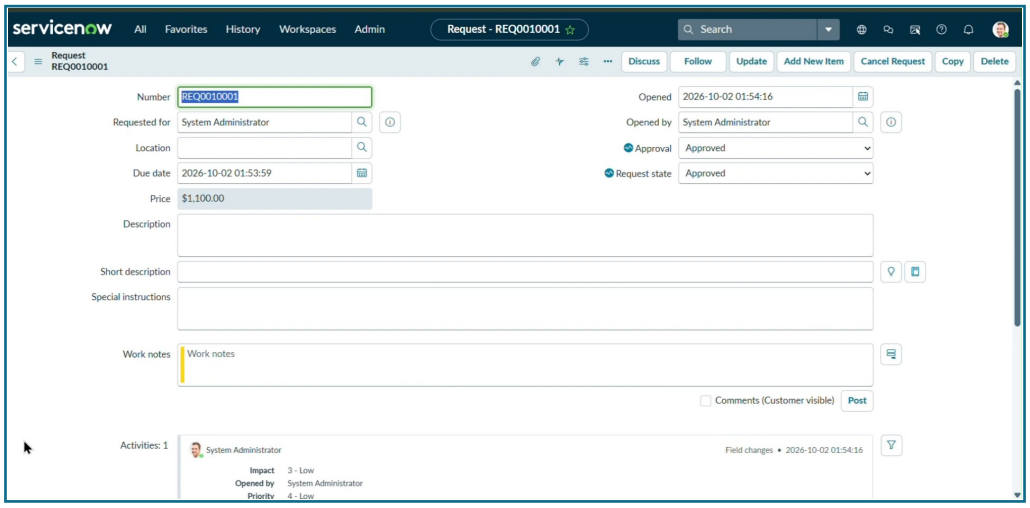


Figure 2: Request REQ0010001 with Approval and Request state set to Approved

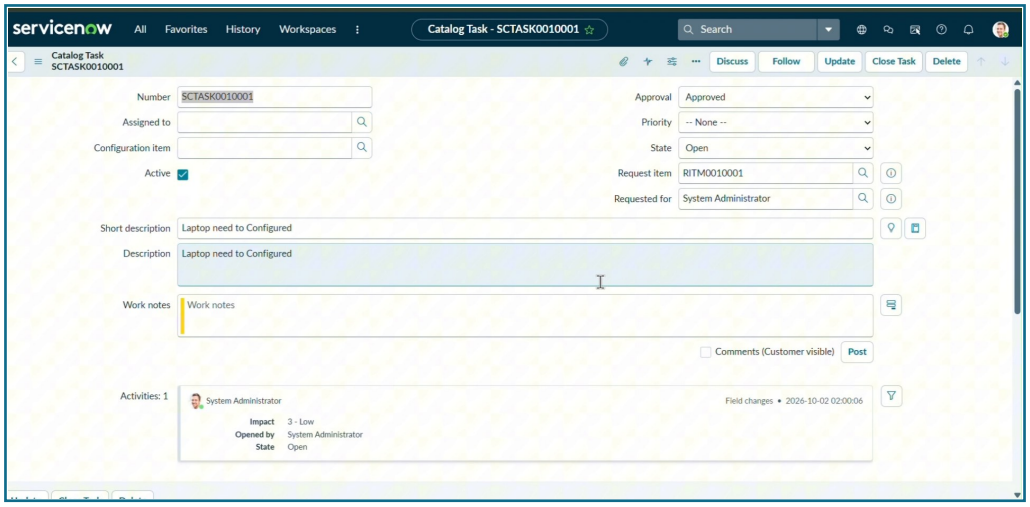


Figure 3: Catalog task SCTASK0010001 created automatically for the approved request